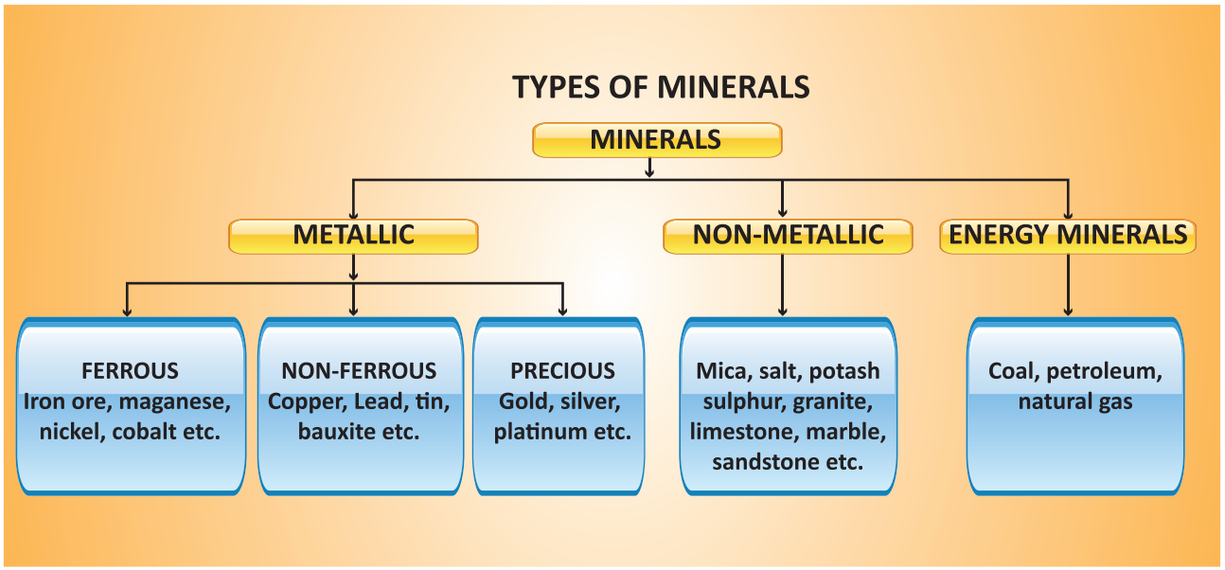



They are exhaustible or non renewable. Besides, they are distributed very unevenly. They are generally found in the form of ores. The ore contains several impurities. Minerals are separated from the ores involving a number of distinct processes.

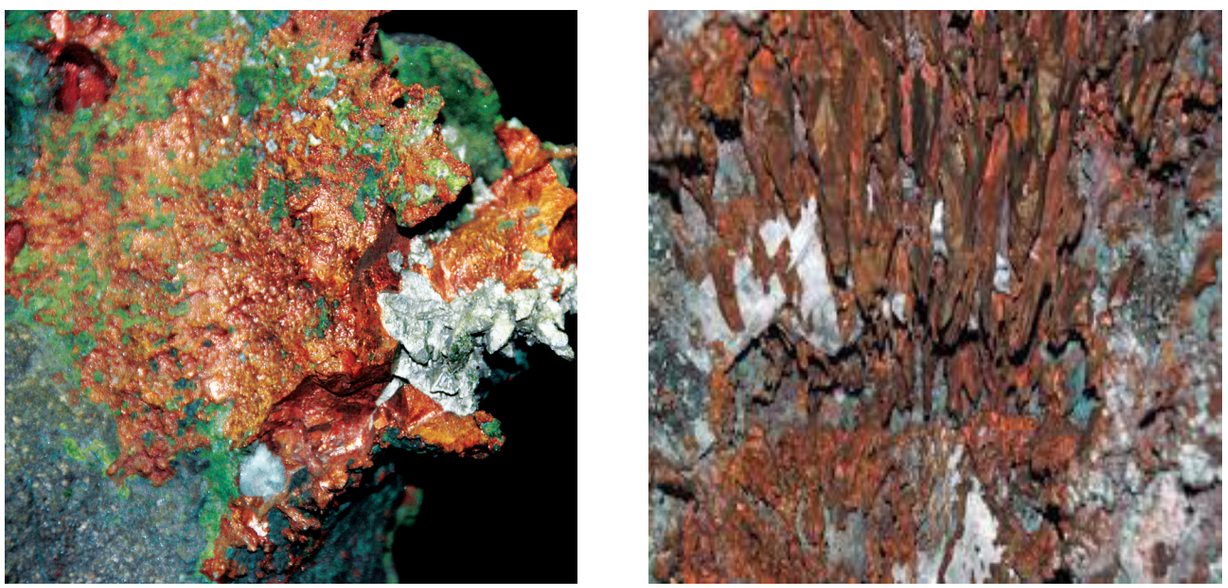
A country's economic development is depending on the minerals. There are several types of minerals, but according to their characteristics and commercial use they are classified as shown in above chart.

## Mode of Occurrence of Minerals

Minerals are generally found in 'Ores'. It is actually an accumulation of any mineral mixed with other elements. Minerals generally occur in many forms. They are

### 1. Veins and lodes

Minerals generally occur in the cracks, crevices, faults and joints of the igneous and metamorphic rocks. Minerals in smaller occurrence are called a 'Vein' and a larger occurrence is called a 'lode, for example, Copper and Gold are found in lodes and veins.



**Copper Lodes**



TN_GOVT_XII_Geography_chapter 03.indd 43 12/6/2022 6:02:30 PM